JUNIPER SALON · WHAT WE HEARD

Every last-minute cancellation turns you and Carla into a text-message switchboard

1. Open the Google Sheet of clients wanting an earlier slot
2. Find a match: service, time, and stylist if they insist on one
3. Text them from the salon phone
4. **Wait and keep checking for a reply**
   Between clients, at the front desk, on the floor
5. **No reply or a “no”? Text the next person**
   …and start watching again

↻ **Repeats until the slot is filled or the day runs out**

YOUR RULES

- One client at a time, earliest on the waitlist first
- Same-day openings: **15 minutes** to accept or decline
- No reply doesn’t cost anyone their place on the waitlist
- When someone accepts, hold the slot while staff check Square

WHAT MATTERS

- Less staff time chasing replies
- More cancelled appointments filled
- Never double-book, and never need constant checking

WHAT THE PROTOTYPE DOES

Each cancelled slot gets its own process that remembers, waits, and moves on, so staff don’t have to

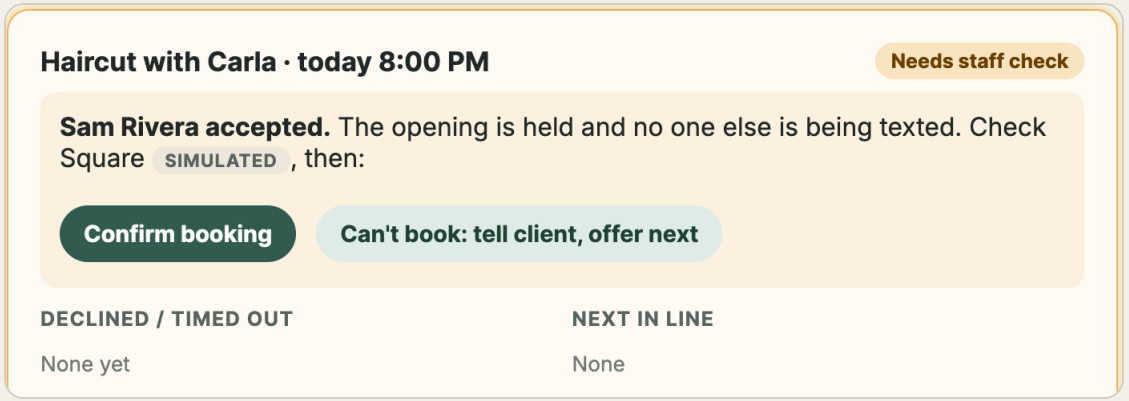
1. **Texts the earliest eligible client, one at a time.** It remembers who holds the offer, and only that client’s reply counts. Late replies and replies from anyone else are turned away.

2. **Keeps track of the 15-minute wait without staff watching the clock.** On a decline or no reply it texts the next eligible client. Clients who don’t reply keep their place.

3. **Someone accepts → the slot is held** and no one else is texted. STAFF Check Square, then *Confirm* (the client is marked booked and gets no more offers) or *Can’t book* (that client is told, stays on the waitlist, and the next is offered).

4. **The opening disappears** (original client returns, stylist is out). STAFF *Opening is gone*: the current client is told and outreach stops. No one else is offered it.

How it stays on track: each opening is run by Temporal, a durable coordinator. It remembers the current step, waits for a reply or the 15-minute deadline, and continues the outreach on its own. The same stylist and time can’t be logged twice.



Sam accepted the 8:00 PM opening. It is held while staff check Square.

#	Client	Wants	Availability	
1	Maya Chen +1 555-0101	Haircut · Carla preferred	Any day afternoon, evening	BOOKED
2	Priya Shah +1 555-0102	Color · Lena only	Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri morning	Remove
3	Alex Kim +1 555-0103	Haircut · Lena only	Any day morning, afternoon, evening	Remove
4	Jordan Lee +1 555-0104	Haircut	Any day morning, afternoon, evening	BOOKED

Maya and Jordan were booked into earlier openings, so they are marked **Booked** and weren’t offered this one.

Prototype dashboard, demo timing (30-second reply window; normally 15 minutes). Sample clients only.

WHERE THE PROTOTYPE STANDS

The offer process works in the prototype; the texts, waitlist sheet, and Square check are stand-ins

Works in the prototype

Covered by automated tests and checked on a local setup

- Matching on service, availability, and required stylist
- One client at a time, earliest first
- 15-minute reply window (shortened to 30 seconds for demos)
- Automatic move to the next client after a decline or no reply
- Slot held after an accept; *Confirm*, *Can't book*, *Opening is gone*
- Same stylist + time can't be logged twice; booked clients get no more offers
- Staff dashboard

Simulated

Stand-ins so the process can be shown safely

- **Waitlist:** six made-up clients inside the app, not your Google Sheet
- **Texts:** shown on on-screen "phones"; nothing is sent
- **Square check:** staff check it themselves and press a button
- **"Booked" status:** kept only inside the prototype, not synced with Square

Not built

Needed before real use

- Real texting, Square, and Google Sheets connections
- Permanent storage of the waitlist and booked status
- Staff logins
- Understanding typed replies (only Accept / Decline)
- Openings on later days

No real clients have been texted. The prototype is not ready for daily use.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Next: settle the open questions and connect your real systems, then test them before a small supervised pilot

1

Settle open questions

- Rules for openings on later days
- Remind staff if a held slot isn’t confirmed?
- Someone asks to be removed while holding an offer
- Text wording and opt-out

2

Connect real systems

- Texting from a salon number, with “STOP” to opt out
- Your real waitlist instead of sample clients
- Square, for checking the slot is still free

3

Test the connections

- Staff phones and test bookings only
- Texts arrive, replies are picked up, and Square matches
- Confirm no slot can be double-booked

4

Small supervised pilot

- A limited set of same-day cancellations
- Staff watch every step at first
- Compare slots filled and staff time against today

Start counting now: cancellations, slots filled, and time spent texting give the pilot a baseline. No results are claimed yet; they will come from the pilot.